

6.1 ICT

In order to play a full part in modern society, candidates need to be confident and effective users of ICT. Where appropriate, candidates should be given opportunities to use ICT in order to further their study of Economics.

This section gives examples of opportunities for using ICT during the course. This list is by no means exhaustive and there are other opportunities within the specification. The opportunities are also indicated within the content of Section C by a  symbol. Such opportunities may or may not contribute to the provision of evidence for IT Key Skills. Where such opportunities do contribute, they are identified by the use of the symbol .

ICT Application/Development	Opportunities for Using ICT During the Course
Word Processing/DTP	There are many opportunities within this specification for producing word processed documents. For example, writing a short essay outlining the factors which a producer has to consider when deciding upon a business location (C1.3).
Spreadsheets and Graphs	There are opportunities within this specification for candidates to devise graphs and spreadsheets. Spreadsheets could be used, for example, when looking at demand and supply schedules (5.2a, b, c), calculations of price elasticity (5.2d), calculations of costs, revenue, profit and break even (5.2e, f, g), calculations of the balance of payments on current account (5.4c). Graphs could be constructed to show production possibility boundaries (5.1b) and demand and supply curves (5.2a, b, c). Diagrams could be produced to show government income and revenue (5.3a) and international trading patterns (5.4c). These could, of course, be devised through spreadsheet figures.
Databases	Opportunities include, for example, using a database to collect and analyse information about individual demand and supply schedules (5.2a, b), government income and expenditure (5.3a) and changes in the full range of macro-economic variables (5.3a, b, c, 5.4c).

Graphics	Candidates can use 'clipart' (and similar) packages to add appropriate symbols/graphics to any written work which is produced using information technology.
Internet/Web Sites	There are many opportunities within this specification for candidates to obtain information from web sites. All candidates should, in fact, be encouraged to obtain the most up to date information on macro-economic variables from government (e.g. ONS, the Treasury) and commercial web sites. There are also a number of specific economic/business related web sites which have been created to help and develop own learning (e.g. BizEd.ac.uk). See Section 8 (Reading list) for a list of useful web sites.
Combining Information	Candidates could combine information from different sources, for example, by writing a report to illustrate government income and expenditure, using figures obtained from a web site. This could include tables/pie charts to illustrate sources of income and areas of spending, a bar chart to show the difference between total income and total expenditure, and a list of bullet points to show the reasons for taxation (IT 2.3).